

Meet Them in Music

Music Class Learning Snapshot

by Dr. P. Eric Bottorff · meettheminmusic.com

STUDENT NAME (FIRST OR INITIALS)

GRADE

SCHOOL YEAR

COMPLETED BY

DATE

About this snapshot: This tool helps music teachers understand a student's needs in the specific context of a music classroom. It is not a clinical assessment. It may be completed by the music teacher (from observation or IEP review), or collaboratively with a special educator or related service provider. Consult with OT, PT, and/or Behavior Interventionists.

SECTION 1 — WHAT WE KNOW Draw from IEP notes, evaluation reports, or input from a special educator or related service provider.

Notes from evaluations / IEP / team

In this music classroom, this might look like:

Auditory processing and sound sensitivity

e.g., hypersensitivity, hyposensitivity, auditory discrimination, central auditory processing

e.g., drum entries, group singing volume, room acoustics, instrument timbre, echo in the space

Movement, body awareness, and physical participation

e.g., vestibular needs, proprioceptive seeking, gross motor coordination, balance

e.g., circle games, instrument handling, movement activities, proximity to other students

Self-regulation, triggers, and calming strategies

e.g., known triggers, de-escalation supports, preferred regulation strategies

e.g., unpredictable sounds, transitions between songs, waiting during instruction, performance demands

Communication and participation style

e.g., verbal output, AAC device use, echolalia, gestural communication, response latency

e.g., call-and-response songs, echo singing, choice-making, group vs. solo participation

QUICK REFERENCE — Common terms and what they may look like in a music classroom**Auditory hypersensitivity:**

May cover ears, leave the circle, or shut down when volume rises suddenly. Watch for reactions to drums, cymbals, group singing, or room echo.

Auditory hyposensitivity:

May seek louder sounds or not respond to verbal cues alone. Pair spoken instruction with visual supports or physical demonstration.

Vestibular seeking:

May rock, spin, or bounce, and often needs more movement than a typical song provides. Movement songs and active games may help with regulation.

Tactile defensiveness:

May resist hand-to-hand instrument passing or neighbor contact in circle games. Individual mallets, handles, or personal instrument sets may help.

Proprioceptive seeking:

Often engages well with drums, resonator bars, or instruments requiring physical force. May need heavy-work input to regulate before finer participation.

Demand avoidance:

Choice-based participation tends to work better than direct instruction or performance demands. Offer two clear options and honor the choice.

SECTION 2 — WHAT I'M NOTICING Add dated entries as you learn. Be specific — note the song, the moment, the context.

Date	What I noticed (song, moment, context)	What seemed to help	What I want to try next